



Startup Lab 2026: Design Associate

Apply

 Schaumburg

JOB DESCRIPTION

You and your team will build a new product from the ground up in 3 months. Your team will be small, flat, and cross functional. Find the right problems to solve, understand root cause, and ensure it is addressed with an elegant, well-designed solution. This is a founder-style environment where roles overlap and evolve. You are expected to bring your specialized skills to bear for your team but prepare to wear as many hats as it takes to get the job done. Individual performance matters, but success is ultimately measured by the progress of your team's startup. Startup Lab Design Associates can expect to:

- Assist your team as necessary to find product-market fit and launch an MVP
- Gather customer feedback and translating it into actionable insights.
- Analyze findings to clearly define user needs and translate them into actionable design goals.
- Iterate on designs based on feedback from users, investors, and team members.
- Design and deliver user process flows, prototypes, mockups and wireframes optimized for the domain of relevant devices and interfaces.
- Develop the confidence to take new ideas from concept to reality.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Currently pursuing or recently completed a Bachelor's or advanced degree in User Experience Design, Human Computer Interaction, or related field from a top-tier university/college, or able to demonstrate significant professional work experience.
- Open minded, curious learner, and comfortable with ambiguity.
- Strong interpersonal, communication, and organizational skills.
- Depth of skill in UX Design and Research, with the patience and willingness to collaborate across other disciplines.
- Strong knowledge of Figma required.
- Entrepreneurial mindset, biased towards action, comfortable with fast-paced environment. Startup experience is a plus.
- You must be **fully** available—onsite—from June 1, 2026 through August 28, 2026.

COMPENSATION & PERKS

- Competitive salary based on experience
 - Opportunities for travel
 - Social and team-building events, like K1-Speed, rock-climbing, and more.
 - Fully stocked kitchen with assorted drinks & snacks
 - Professional development through mentors, training, and networking
 - Future opportunities—simplified pathway to employment
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Apply for this job

* indicates a required field

First Name *

Last Name *

Email *

Country *



Phone *

Resume/CV *

Attach

Enter manually

Accepted file types: pdf, doc, docx, txt, rtf

Cover Letter *

Attach

Enter manually

Accepted file types: pdf, doc, docx, txt, rtf

Education

School *

Select...



Degree *

Select...



Discipline *

Select...



Start date month *

Select...



Start date year *

End date month *

Select...



End date year *

[Add another](#)

Home City, State, Country *

Where do you call “home”?

City, State, Country of your School *

Where do you live when you’re at school?

When is your last final before summer 2026? *

The 2026 program begins on June 1st, 2026. You must arrive by the evening of May 31st, 2026. No exceptions.

On what specific date do your fall semester classes begin? *

You will be required to stay with the program through 28 August 2026.

What is your expected graduation date? *

Please provide the month and the year.

Do you understand and agree to the Startup Lab travel policy? *

Select...

1. Travel Policy: The Startup Lab is a demanding, fast-paced, immersive experience. Undisclosed travel, even on weekends, can impact outcomes and create an unfair burden on your team. We understand associates may have conflicts, but the No Travel policy stands. Undisclosed travel may result in termination of employment and exit from the Startup Lab.

Do you require a CPT, OPT, or other type of visa to work in the US? *

Select...

It's okay if you are working under a CPT or OPT visa; we just need to know as soon as possible to make sure we have time to process everything.

How did you hear about us? *

Please be as specific as possible. If you were referred, please name the person and their relationship to Fulcrum, the program, and to you.

LinkedIn Profile *

GitHub or Design Portfolio link *

List up to 3 tools, technologies, or business skills you'd like to add to your toolkit. Why are these priorities for your growth and development? *

Tell us about 3 industries or verticals you're interested in. Tell us why you find each of these

interesting. *



Is there a particular business function or process of interest to you? *



Tell us anything not included in your resume or portfolio that you'd like us to know about? *



Voluntary Self-Identification

For government reporting purposes, we ask candidates to respond to the below self-identification survey. Completion of the form is entirely voluntary. Whatever your decision, it will not be considered in the hiring process or thereafter. Any information that you do provide will be recorded and maintained in a confidential file.

As set forth in Fulcrum GT—Startup Lab [2026]’s Equal Employment Opportunity policy, we do not discriminate on the basis of any protected group status under any applicable law.

Gender

Select...



Are you Hispanic/Latino?

Select...



[Race & Ethnicity Definitions](#)

If you believe you belong to any of the categories of protected veterans listed below, please indicate by making the appropriate selection. As a government contractor subject to the Vietnam Era Veterans Readjustment Assistance Act (VEVRAA), we request this information

in order to measure the effectiveness of the outreach and positive recruitment efforts we undertake pursuant to VEVRAA. Classification of protected categories is as follows:

A "disabled veteran" is one of the following: a veteran of the U.S. military, ground, naval or air service who is entitled to compensation (or who but for the receipt of military retired pay would be entitled to compensation) under laws administered by the Secretary of Veterans Affairs; or a person who was discharged or released from active duty because of a service-connected disability.

A "recently separated veteran" means any veteran during the three-year period beginning on the date of such veteran's discharge or release from active duty in the U.S. military, ground, naval, or air service.

An "active duty wartime or campaign badge veteran" means a veteran who served on active duty in the U.S. military, ground, naval or air service during a war, or in a campaign or expedition for which a campaign badge has been authorized under the laws administered by the Department of Defense.

An "Armed forces service medal veteran" means a veteran who, while serving on active duty in the U.S. military, ground, naval or air service, participated in a United States military operation for which an Armed Forces service medal was awarded pursuant to Executive Order 12985.

Veteran Status
Select... ▼

Voluntary Self-Identification of Disability

Form CC-305

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OMB Control Number 1250-0005

Expires 04/30/2026

Why are you being asked to complete this form?

We are a federal contractor or subcontractor. The law requires us to provide equal employment opportunity to qualified people with disabilities. We have a goal of having at least 7% of our workers as people with disabilities. The law says we must measure our progress towards this goal. To do this, we must ask applicants and employees if they have a disability or have ever had one. People can become disabled, so we need to ask this question at least every five years.

Completing this form is voluntary, and we hope that you will choose to do so. Your answer is confidential. No one who makes hiring decisions will see it. Your decision to complete the

confidential. No one who makes hiring decisions will see it. Your decision to complete the form and your answer will not harm you in any way. If you want to learn more about the law or this form, visit the U.S. Department of Labor's Office of Federal Contract Compliance Programs (OFCCP) website at www.dol.gov/ofccp.

How do you know if you have a disability?

A disability is a condition that substantially limits one or more of your "major life activities." If you have or have ever had such a condition, you are a person with a disability. **Disabilities include, but are not limited to:**

- Alcohol or other substance use disorder (not currently using drugs illegally)
- Autoimmune disorder, for example, lupus, fibromyalgia, rheumatoid arthritis, HIV/AIDS
- Blind or low vision
- Cancer (past or present)
- Cardiovascular or heart disease
- Celiac disease
- Cerebral palsy
- Deaf or serious difficulty hearing
- Diabetes
- Disfigurement, for example, disfigurement caused by burns, wounds, accidents, or congenital disorders
- Epilepsy or other seizure disorder
- Gastrointestinal disorders, for example, Crohn's Disease, irritable bowel syndrome
- Intellectual or developmental disability
- Mental health conditions, for example, depression, bipolar disorder, anxiety disorder, schizophrenia, PTSD
- Missing limbs or partially missing limbs
- Mobility impairment, benefiting from the use of a wheelchair, scooter, walker, leg brace(s) and/or other supports
- Nervous system condition, for example, migraine headaches, Parkinson's disease, multiple sclerosis (MS)
- Neurodivergence, for example, attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), autism spectrum disorder, dyslexia, dyspraxia, other learning disabilities
- Partial or complete paralysis (any cause)
- Pulmonary or respiratory conditions, for example, tuberculosis, asthma, emphysema
- Short stature (dwarfism)
- Traumatic brain injury

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